

Malware Types

Estimated Time: 10 minutes

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Identify common categories of malware.
- Compare and contrast different types of malware.

Malware types

Amidst a rapidly evolving security landscape, malware stands out as one of the most prolific threats to users and systems. Malware, short for malicious software, is a broad term encompassing various software specifically designed to disrupt, damage, or gain unauthorized access to a computer system. Let's delve into the most common categories of malware, each with its unique traits and modes of operation. Understanding these malware types is the first step toward ensuring effective protection and risk mitigation in our increasingly digitalized world.

Malware Type	Description
Adware	A malicious software that displays unwanted advertisements on a user's device.
Bot	An automated software that performs malicious tasks over the internet. The bot malware works alongside other computers infected with the same malware to create a botnet. This botnet is controlled by a command-and-control server responsible for sending out commands.
Fileless malware	A form of malicious software that operates within computer memory without leaving any traces on the file system.
Keylogger	A malware that records keystrokes on a computer to capture sensitive information.
Logic bomb	A malicious code that remains dormant until triggered by a specific event or condition.
Malvertising	A malicious advertisement that contains hidden code to deliver malware to users' devices.
Ransomware	A malware that encrypts files on a victim's system and demands a ransom for their release.
Rootkit	A stealthy malware that is designed to gain unauthorized access and control over a computer system.
Spyware	A malicious software that covertly collects user information and internet behavior without their consent, often for advertising purposes.
Trojan	A type of malware that disguises itself as legitimate software, deceiving users into executing malicious code that can lead to data theft or system harm.
Virus	A malicious software that attaches itself to clean files and spreads through a computer system, corrupting data and hindering performance.
Worm	A type of malicious software that often spreads autonomously, proliferating its destructive payload without requiring human facilitation.

